



Tariffs and Trade Winds: Where Do Potatoes Go From Here?

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Potatoes don't typically make headlines in global trade talks. But this year, they've landed squarely on the front lines. The newly signed US-EU tariff agreement, while praised for preventing escalation, raises immediate costs for key potato categories - most notably frozen fries, which now face a 15% tariff when entering the United States. For exporters across Europe, this means one thing: margins are shrinking, even as global competition heats up. For the US potato industry, the picture is more complicated. On one hand, retaliatory tariffs from the EU - some forecast as high as 40% - were avoided. On the other, the cost of essential farming inputs continues to rise due to parallel duties on fertilizers and agri-chemicals. Meanwhile, production in Europe is climbing, especially in countries like the Netherlands, Belgium and Germany, challenging the market dominance of North American processors in export destinations ranging from Asia to the Middle East. This tension - between cooperation and competition, between tariffs and opportunity - will be explored in

The tension between cooperation and competition, between tariffs and opportunity will be explored in one of the key panel discussions at this year's PotatoEurope in Lelystad.

one of the key panel discussions at this year's PotatoEurope in Lelystad, part of a wider agenda addressing the critical challenges and innovations shaping the sector.

In a special panel session titled Europe's Place in a Changing Potato World, experts will tackle the sector's most pressing question: how can Europe stay competitive

in a landscape shaped by shifting trade flows, new players like China and India, and an increasingly complex policy environment?

There may be no simple answer - but one thing is certain: the rules of global potato trade are changing fast. For processors, exporters, and growers alike, now is the time to adapt, invest, and engage.

This issue of Potato Processing International features full coverage of PotatoEurope 2025 - from machinery demonstrations and agronomic trials to expert discussions on trade and market competitiveness. We invite you to explore the insights shared before the show, alongside a wide range of articles on processing technologies, market dynamics, and product innovation shaping the global potato industry. ●

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